

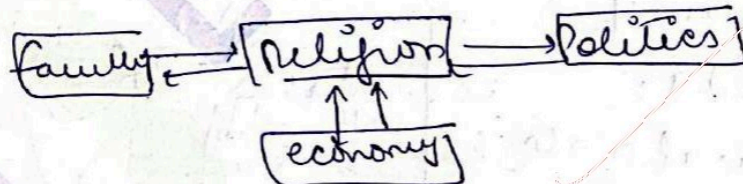
5.c) Religion and Politics

Religion and Politics is studied as a convergence of sociocultural and political anthropology.

Definition of Religion: Prins said, "it is a set of beliefs and practices of the supernatural space along with ceremonial rites to control and interpret the universe of our control."

Religion and Politics in Simple Societies

(1) Religion is a subsystem like Politics.
In structure functional study:-



all systems integrate.

(Eg) Shamans and Priests have power authority in cultures [Eg] Tu'/Hoansi
Shaman commands respect.
They may not have legitimacy.

(Eg) Evans-Pritchard in study of NER said -

The Leopards skin chief has religious and juridical role by virtue of status.

Religion and Politics in Modern Society

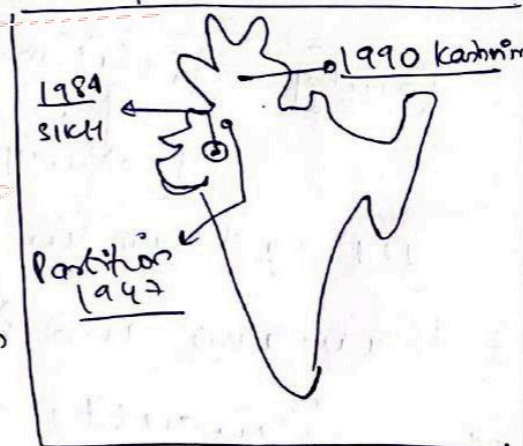
① Usually there is separation of state due to "modern secular principles". (Uniform CIVIL CODE is exception)

② In ethnic movements, religion is a factor to create "ethnic identity".

Paul Brass said Communalism is primordial attachment and vigorously furthering a religious agenda.

Communal riots :

When there is mix of high extreme communalism with politics.



Thus religion and politics manifest differently in different scenarios.